

Banking Domain Knowledge Base

Comprehensive Question and Answer Set — v2 (with Conversational Greetings)

Category	Questions
0. Conversational Greetings and Small Talk	20
1. Account Management	10
2. Card Services	14
3. Transactions and Transfers	14
4. Loans and Credit	14
5. Internet and Mobile Banking	12
6. Deposits and Investments	12
7. Security and Fraud Prevention	12
8. Customer Service	10
9. Fees and Charges	10
10. General Banking	12
TOTAL	140

0. Conversational Greetings and Small Talk

Q0.1: Hello!

Hello! Welcome to our banking assistant. How can I help you today?

Q0.2: Hi there!

Hi! I am here to help you with all your banking needs. What can I assist you with?

Q0.3: Hey, how are you?

I am doing great, thank you for asking! I am ready to assist you with any banking questions or services. What do you need help with?

Q0.4: Good morning!

Good morning! I hope you are having a wonderful day. How can I assist you with your banking needs today?

Q0.5: Good afternoon!

Good afternoon! I am here and ready to help. What banking service can I assist you with?

Q0.6: Good evening!

Good evening! Our digital banking service is available 24/7. How can I help you this evening?

Q0.7: Who are you? What are you?

I am Essam, your AI-powered banking assistant. I can help you with account management, card services, transfers, loans, deposits, security queries, and much more. Just ask me anything related to your banking needs.

Q0.8: Can you help me?

Of course! I am here specifically to help you. Please tell me what you need assistance with and I will do my best to provide you with accurate and helpful information.

Q0.9: Please help me.

Absolutely, I am happy to help. Please go ahead and describe what you need and I will assist you right away.

Q0.10: What can you do?

I can assist you with a wide range of banking services including: checking account balances, explaining transfer options, answering questions about loans and credit cards, guiding you through online banking features, providing information on fees and charges, and helping with security and fraud concerns. Just ask!

Q0.11: I need help.

Of course, I am here to help you. Please describe your issue or question and I will assist you immediately.

Q0.12: Are you a bot or a human?

I am an AI banking assistant. I am designed to help you with your banking queries quickly and accurately. For complex issues that require human intervention, I can guide you to connect with a customer service representative.

Q0.13: Thank you!

You are very welcome! It was my pleasure to assist you. If you have any more questions about your banking needs, feel free to ask anytime.

Q0.14: Thanks a lot!

Happy to help! Do not hesitate to reach out if you have any other banking questions. Have a great day!

Q0.15: Okay, goodbye!

Goodbye! Thank you for using our banking assistant. Have a wonderful day and do not hesitate to come back if you need any help.

Q0.16: Bye!

Bye! Take care. Our banking assistant is available 24/7 whenever you need help.

Q0.17: I have a question.

Of course, go ahead and ask. I am here to answer all your banking-related questions.

Q0.18: I am not sure what I need.

No problem at all. You can start by telling me what is on your mind — whether it is about your account, a transaction, a card, a loan, or anything else banking-related — and I will guide you from there.

Q0.19: Can you speak Arabic?

I primarily communicate in English, but our customer care helpline offers support in multiple languages. Please call the toll-free helpline and select your preferred language from the IVR menu.

Q0.20: This is urgent!

I understand. Please describe your urgent issue immediately and I will prioritize helping you. If your card has been lost or stolen, or if you notice unauthorized transactions, please call our 24/7 emergency helpline right away.

1. Account Management

Q1.1: How do I open a new savings account?

Visit your nearest branch with valid ID proof, address proof, and passport-size photographs. Fill out the account opening form and make the initial deposit. You can also open an account online through the bank's website or mobile app by completing the e-KYC process.

Q1.2: What documents are required to open a checking account?

You typically need: (1) Government-issued photo ID (passport, driver's license, or national ID), (2) Proof of address (utility bill, rental agreement), (3) PAN card or tax identification number, (4) Initial deposit amount, and (5) Passport-size photographs.

Q1.3: How can I close my bank account?

Submit a written account closure request at your branch along with your passbook, debit card, and unused cheque leaves. Ensure all outstanding dues are cleared and standing instructions are cancelled. The remaining balance will be transferred to you via cheque or NEFT.

Q1.4: What is the minimum balance requirement for a savings account?

Minimum balance requirements vary by account type. Basic savings accounts typically require 500-1,000, while regular savings accounts require 5,000-10,000. Premium accounts may require 25,000 or more. Failure to maintain the minimum balance may attract penalty charges.

Q1.5: How do I update my contact information in my account?

Log in to internet banking or visit your branch with valid ID proof. You can update your mobile number, email address, and mailing address. Some updates may require OTP verification on your registered mobile number.

Q1.6: Can I have multiple accounts at the same bank?

Yes, you can hold multiple accounts at the same bank such as a savings account, a current account, and a salary account simultaneously. Each account will have its own account number, and you can manage them all through a single internet banking login.

Q1.7: What are the fees associated with maintaining a checking account?

Common fees include monthly maintenance charges (100-500), non-maintenance of minimum balance fee (100-750 per quarter), cheque book charges, and ATM usage fees beyond the free limit. Some accounts offer zero-fee structures if a minimum balance is maintained.

Q1.8: How do I switch from a basic account to a premium account?

Visit your branch or submit an upgrade request through internet banking. You will need to meet the eligibility criteria for the premium account. The bank will review your profile and process the upgrade, usually within 2-5 working days.

Q1.9: What is the difference between a joint account and an individual account?

An individual account is operated by a single person. A joint account is shared by two or more people and can be operated based on the mode set: Either or Survivor (any one can operate), Former or Survivor (only the primary holder), or Jointly (all holders must sign together).

Q1.10: How can I view my account statement online?

Log in to your internet banking portal or mobile app, navigate to Account Statement or Transaction History, select the date range, and view or download the statement in PDF or Excel format. Statements are also available via email if you have subscribed to e-statements.

2. Card Services

Q2.1: How do I activate my new debit card?

You can activate your debit card by: (1) Using it at any ATM with your PIN, (2) Calling the bank's customer service IVR, (3) Logging into internet banking and selecting Activate Card, or (4) Sending an SMS in the prescribed format to the bank's number.

Q2.2: How do I activate my credit card?

Activate your credit card by calling the number on the sticker attached to the card, or through internet banking under Card Services > Activate Card. You may need to set a PIN via the bank's IVR, ATM, or mobile app before use.

Q2.3: What should I do if my card is lost or stolen?

Immediately block your card by calling the 24/7 customer care helpline, using the mobile banking app, or logging into internet banking. Report the loss to the bank formally and request a replacement card. Also file a police report if fraud has occurred.

Q2.4: How can I request a replacement card?

Log in to your internet banking or mobile app, go to Card Services, and select Request Replacement Card. Alternatively, visit your branch or call customer care. The new card will be delivered to your registered address within 5-7 working days.

Q2.5: What is my card's daily withdrawal limit?

Standard debit cards have a daily ATM withdrawal limit of 10,000-50,000 and a POS/online transaction limit of 1,00,000-2,00,000, depending on your card variant. You can check or request a limit change through internet banking or customer care.

Q2.6: How do I change my card PIN?

Change your PIN at any bank ATM by selecting PIN Change from the menu. You can also change it through the mobile banking app under Card Settings > Set/Change PIN, or by calling the IVR helpline.

Q2.7: Can I use my card for international transactions?

International usage may be disabled by default for security reasons. You can enable it through your mobile app under Card Controls > International Transactions or by calling customer care. Foreign currency transactions attract a markup fee of typically 2-3.5%.

Q2.8: How do I report unauthorized transactions on my card?

Immediately call the 24/7 customer care helpline or report via the mobile app under Dispute a Transaction. Block the card to prevent further misuse. The bank will initiate a chargeback investigation, which may take 7-45 working days to resolve.

Q2.9: What are the charges for using my card at ATMs?

Most banks offer 3-5 free ATM transactions per month at their own ATMs and 3 free transactions at other bank ATMs. Beyond the free limit, charges are typically 20-21 per financial transaction and 8-10 per non-financial transaction.

Q2.10: How can I increase my credit card limit?

Submit a limit enhancement request through internet banking, mobile app, or by calling customer care. The bank will assess your credit score, income, and repayment history. Approval typically takes 3-7 working days.

Q2.11: What is the difference between a debit card and a credit card?

A debit card directly deducts money from your bank account when used. A credit card allows you to borrow money from the bank up to a set credit limit, which must be repaid by the due date. Credit cards may offer rewards and EMI options but can attract interest if not paid in full.

Q2.12: How do I block my card temporarily?

You can temporarily block your card through the mobile banking app under Card Controls > Block/Unblock Card, or via internet banking. A temporarily blocked card can be unblocked anytime, unlike a permanently blocked card which requires a replacement.

Q2.13: Can I get a virtual card for online shopping?

Yes, many banks offer virtual debit or credit cards for secure online shopping. You can generate a virtual card through the mobile banking app or internet banking. Virtual cards have unique numbers, CVVs, and expiry dates, providing an extra layer of security.

Q2.14: What is contactless payment and how do I enable it?

Contactless payment allows you to tap your card on a compatible POS terminal to pay without entering a PIN for transactions up to 5,000 in India. It is enabled by default on NFC-enabled cards. You can enable or disable it through the mobile app under Card Controls.

3. Transactions and Transfers

Q3.1: How do I transfer money to another account?

Log in to your internet banking or mobile app, go to Fund Transfer, select the transfer type (NEFT/RTGS/IMPS), add the beneficiary details, enter the amount, and confirm with OTP. You can also transfer money via UPI using the recipient's UPI ID or mobile number.

Q3.2: What is the limit for online money transfers?

IMPS: Up to 5 lakh per transaction. NEFT: No upper limit (bank-defined daily limits apply). RTGS: Minimum 2 lakh, no upper limit. UPI: Up to 1 lakh per transaction (2 lakh for certain categories). Daily limits may vary by bank and account type.

Q3.3: How long does a wire transfer take?

Domestic wire transfers (RTGS/NEFT) are processed within 30 minutes to 2 hours on working days. IMPS transfers are instant, 24/7. International wire transfers (SWIFT) typically take 1-5 working days depending on the destination country and intermediary banks.

Q3.4: What are the charges for domestic transfers?

NEFT charges range from 2-25 depending on the amount. RTGS charges are 20-50 for amounts above 2 lakh. IMPS charges are typically 5-15 per transaction. Many banks offer free NEFT/RTGS transfers through internet banking and mobile apps.

Q3.5: What are the charges for international transfers?

International transfer charges include a flat fee of 500-2,000 plus a foreign exchange markup of 2-3.5% on the exchange rate. Additional correspondent bank charges may apply. The exact charges depend on the destination country and the amount being transferred.

Q3.6: How do I set up automatic payments?

Log in to internet banking, go to Payments > Standing Instructions / Auto Pay, and add the payee details, amount, frequency (monthly/weekly), and start date. You can set up automatic bill payments, loan EMI, and recurring transfers this way.

Q3.7: Can I schedule future-dated transfers?

Yes, you can schedule future-dated transfers through internet banking or the mobile app. Go to Fund Transfer, enter the details, and select a future date for execution. The system will process the transfer on the specified date, provided sufficient funds are available.

Q3.8: How do I cancel a pending transaction?

Cancellation of pending transactions depends on the transfer type. NEFT batch transactions can sometimes be recalled before processing. IMPS and RTGS transactions cannot be reversed once initiated. Contact customer care immediately if you need to attempt a recall.

Q3.9: What is SWIFT code and when do I need it?

SWIFT code is an 8-11 character code that identifies a specific bank globally. You need it when sending or receiving international wire transfers. Your bank's SWIFT code is available on the bank's website and on your account statement.

Q3.10: How do I add a beneficiary for money transfer?

Log in to internet banking, go to Manage Beneficiaries > Add Beneficiary, enter the account number, IFSC code, and name, then confirm with OTP. New beneficiaries typically have a cooling period of 30 minutes to 24 hours before funds can be transferred.

Q3.11: What is RTGS and how does it work?

RTGS (Real Time Gross Settlement) is an electronic funds transfer system where transactions are processed in real time. It is used for high-value transfers of 2 lakh and above. RTGS operates 24x7 and funds are immediately credited to the beneficiary's account.

Q3.12: What is NEFT and what are its timings?

NEFT (National Electronic Funds Transfer) operates in half-hourly batches, 24 hours a day, 365 days a year. Unlike RTGS, there is no minimum transfer amount. Settlement happens in batches, so transfers may take up to 2 hours.

Q3.13: How do I track my transaction status?

Log in to internet banking or the mobile app and navigate to Transaction History or Payment Status. Enter the transaction reference number (UTR/RRN) to check the status. You can also call customer care with your reference number for an update.

Q3.14: Can I reverse a completed transaction?

Completed transactions generally cannot be reversed automatically. You can raise a transaction dispute or request a recall through customer care. Success depends on whether the beneficiary's bank agrees to return the funds. Always verify payee details before transferring money.

4. Loans and Credit

Q4.1: What types of loans does the bank offer?

The bank offers a wide range of loans including: Personal Loans, Home Loans, Car/Auto Loans, Education Loans, Business Loans, Loan Against Property, Gold Loans, and Two-Wheeler Loans. Each loan type has specific eligibility criteria, interest rates, and repayment terms.

Q4.2: How do I apply for a personal loan?

Apply online via the bank's website or mobile app, or visit your nearest branch. You will need to submit identity proof, address proof, income documents (salary slips, IT returns), and bank statements. Loan approval is typically within 24-72 hours for eligible applicants.

Q4.3: What is the interest rate on home loans?

Home loan interest rates typically range from 8.5% to 11% per annum, depending on the loan amount, tenure, credit score, and whether you choose a fixed or floating rate. Rates are linked to the bank's MCLR or external benchmark rate and are subject to periodic revision.

Q4.4: What documents are needed for a car loan?

Required documents include: identity proof, address proof, income proof (salary slips or IT returns for 2 years), bank statements (6 months), passport-size photos, and the vehicle's proforma invoice. Self-employed applicants may need additional business documents.

Q4.5: How is my loan eligibility calculated?

Loan eligibility is calculated based on your monthly income, existing EMIs, credit score, employment type and stability, age, and the loan tenure. Typically, your total EMI obligations should not exceed 40-50% of your net monthly income.

Q4.6: Can I prepay my loan without penalty?

For floating-rate loans, RBI guidelines prohibit banks from charging prepayment penalties on individual borrowers. For fixed-rate loans, prepayment charges of 2-5% of the outstanding loan amount may apply. Check your loan agreement for the specific terms.

Q4.7: How do I check my loan balance?

You can check your outstanding loan balance through internet banking under Loan Accounts, via the mobile banking app, by calling customer care, or by visiting your branch. Your monthly EMI statement also shows the outstanding principal and interest breakup.

Q4.8: What is EMI and how is it calculated?

EMI (Equated Monthly Installment) is the fixed monthly payment made to repay a loan. It is calculated using the formula: $EMI = P \times r \times (1+r)^n / ((1+r)^n - 1)$, where P is the principal, r is the monthly interest rate, and n is the number of months.

Q4.9: How can I get my loan statement?

Download your loan statement from internet banking or the mobile app under Loan Accounts > Statement. You can also request a physical statement at your branch or by calling customer care. Annual loan statements are often sent to your registered email address.

Q4.10: What happens if I miss an EMI payment?

Missing an EMI results in a late payment penalty (typically 2-3% per annum on the overdue amount), a negative impact on your credit score (CIBIL), and potential legal action if payments are missed repeatedly. Contact the bank immediately to discuss restructuring options.

Q4.11: Can I restructure my existing loan?

Yes, loan restructuring is possible in cases of financial hardship. You may request an extension of tenure (which reduces EMI), a moratorium, or a change in repayment structure. Note that restructuring may affect your credit score.

Q4.12: What is the processing fee for loans?

Processing fees vary by loan type: Personal loans: 1-3% of loan amount; Home loans: 0.25-1%; Car loans: 0.5-2%; Education loans: Nil to 1%. Processing fees are generally non-refundable even if the loan is not disbursed. GST at 18% is also applicable on the processing fee.

Q4.13: How long does loan approval take?

Pre-approved personal loans can be disbursed instantly. Standard personal loans take 1-3 working days. Home loans take 7-15 working days depending on property document verification. Car loans take 1-3 days. Timelines depend on the completeness of your documentation.

Q4.14: What is the difference between fixed and floating interest rates?

A fixed interest rate remains constant throughout the loan tenure, offering predictable EMIs. A floating rate changes with market conditions (linked to MCLR or repo rate), meaning your EMI can increase or decrease. Floating rates are generally lower initially but carry interest rate risk.

5. Internet and Mobile Banking

Q5.1: How do I register for internet banking?

Visit the bank's website, click Register for Internet Banking, and enter your account number, registered mobile number, and debit card details. Verify with OTP, set a username and password. Alternatively, registration can be done at your branch or ATM.

Q5.2: How do I reset my online banking password?

Click Forgot Password on the login page, enter your user ID and registered mobile number, verify with OTP, and set a new password. You can also reset it via the mobile app or by calling customer care and completing the IVR-based reset process.

Q5.3: Is mobile banking secure?

Yes, mobile banking uses multiple layers of security including 128/256-bit SSL encryption, two-factor authentication (OTP), biometric login (fingerprint/face ID), and session timeout. Always download the app from official stores and avoid using public Wi-Fi for banking transactions.

Q5.4: How do I download the mobile banking app?

Search for the bank's official app name on the Google Play Store (Android) or Apple App Store (iOS). Ensure you download the official app published by the bank. Avoid downloading apps from third-party websites. The app is free to download and use.

Q5.5: What services are available on mobile banking?

Mobile banking offers: account balance and statement viewing, fund transfers (NEFT/RTGS/IMPS/UPI), bill payments and recharges, credit/debit card management, FD/RD account opening, loan EMI payments, cheque services, investment options, and 24/7 customer support access.

Q5.6: How do I enable two-factor authentication?

Two-factor authentication (2FA) is usually enabled by default for all transactions. You can manage 2FA settings in the mobile app under Security Settings. OTP-based verification is mandatory for high-value transactions, new payee additions, and profile changes.

Q5.7: Can I pay bills through internet banking?

Yes, you can pay utility bills (electricity, water, gas), mobile/DTH recharges, insurance premiums, tax payments, and more through internet banking. Go to Payments > Bill Pay, add the biller, enter the amount, and confirm with OTP.

Q5.8: How do I add a payee in online banking?

Log in to internet banking, go to Manage Payees > Add Payee, enter the payee's account details (account number, IFSC code, name), and confirm with OTP. A cooling period of up to 30 minutes or 24 hours may apply before you can transact with a new payee.

Q5.9: What should I do if I am locked out of my account?

Use the Forgot Password or Unlock Account option on the login page. If that does not work, call customer care with your account details for identity verification and account unlocking. Accounts are typically locked after 3-5 failed login attempts for security.

Q5.10: How do I generate a transaction password?

A transaction password can be generated through internet banking under Security Settings > Transaction Password, or via the IVR helpline. Some banks use OTPs instead of a fixed transaction password for each transaction.

Q5.11: Can I open a fixed deposit through mobile banking?

Yes, you can open an FD directly through the mobile banking app. Go to Deposits > Open Fixed Deposit, enter the amount and tenure, choose the interest payout option, and confirm. The funds will be debited from your linked savings account instantly.

Q5.12: How do I update my mobile number for banking?

To update your registered mobile number, visit your branch with ID proof and fill out a mobile number change request form. Some banks allow this via internet banking with enhanced verification. This is a sensitive update and usually cannot be done over the phone alone.

6. Deposits and Investments

Q6.1: What is a fixed deposit and how does it work?

A Fixed Deposit (FD) is a savings instrument where you deposit a lump sum for a fixed tenure at a predetermined interest rate. The bank pays interest at maturity or periodically based on your choice. FDs offer higher interest rates than savings accounts and guaranteed returns.

Q6.2: What are the interest rates for fixed deposits?

FD interest rates typically range from 6% to 8.5% per annum, depending on the tenure, deposit amount, and the bank's current rate card. Senior citizens usually get an additional 0.25-0.50% over the regular rate. Rates are subject to periodic revision by the bank.

Q6.3: Can I break my fixed deposit before maturity?

Yes, you can break (prematurely withdraw) an FD before maturity, but a penalty of 0.5-1% may be deducted from the applicable interest rate. The penalty varies by bank and tenure. Some tax-saving FDs with a 5-year lock-in cannot be broken prematurely.

Q6.4: What is a recurring deposit?

A Recurring Deposit (RD) is a savings scheme where you deposit a fixed amount every month for a predetermined tenure. At maturity, you receive the total deposited amount plus accumulated interest. RDs are ideal for building savings through regular monthly contributions.

Q6.5: How do I open a fixed deposit account?

Open an FD via internet banking, mobile app, or by visiting a branch. Choose the deposit amount, tenure (7 days to 10 years), and interest payout method (monthly, quarterly, or at maturity). The amount is debited from your savings account and the FD is created instantly online.

Q6.6: What is the minimum amount for starting an FD?

The minimum FD amount varies by bank but is typically 1,000 for regular FDs. Some banks allow FDs starting from 100 for digital platforms. For bulk deposits and special rate FDs, the minimum amount may be 1 crore or more.

Q6.7: Are my deposits insured?

Yes, deposits in Indian banks are insured by the Deposit Insurance and Credit Guarantee Corporation (DICGC). Each depositor is insured up to 5 lakh per bank across all deposits including savings, FD, and RD accounts. This insurance is automatic and free.

Q6.8: What is the tenure for fixed deposits?

FD tenures range from 7 days to 10 years. Short-term FDs: 7 days to 1 year. Medium-term: 1-3 years. Long-term: 3-10 years. Tax-saving FDs have a mandatory lock-in of 5 years. Higher interest rates are generally offered for tenures of 1-3 years.

Q6.9: How is interest calculated on savings accounts?

Savings account interest is calculated on the daily closing balance and credited quarterly or monthly. The interest rate is typically 2.5-7% per annum. Formula: $\text{Interest} = (\text{Daily Balance} \times \text{Rate} \times \text{Days}) / 365$. Interest earned above 10,000 per year is taxable.

Q6.10: Can I get a loan against my fixed deposit?

Yes, you can get an overdraft or loan against your FD of up to 90% of its value. The interest rate on such loans is typically 1-2% above the FD rate, making it one of the cheapest borrowing options. The FD continues to earn interest during the loan period.

Q6.11: What are mutual funds and does the bank offer them?

Mutual funds pool money from investors and invest in a diversified portfolio of stocks, bonds, or other securities. Banks offer mutual fund investment services through their branches or digital platforms. You can invest via SIP (monthly installments) or lump sum, subject to market risks.

Q6.12: How do I invest in government bonds through the bank?

You can invest in government securities, RBI Bonds, and Sovereign Gold Bonds through the bank's internet banking platform or RBI Retail Direct portal. Speak to your bank's investment advisor or relationship manager for guidance on suitable government bond options.

7. Security and Fraud Prevention

Q7.1: How can I protect my account from fraud?

Key steps include: never sharing your PIN, OTP, or password; using strong, unique passwords; enabling transaction alerts; avoiding public Wi-Fi for banking; regularly monitoring account statements; using the bank's official app and website; and enabling two-factor authentication.

Q7.2: What is phishing and how do I avoid it?

Phishing is a fraud attempt where criminals impersonate banks through fake emails, SMS, or calls to steal your credentials. Avoid it by: never clicking suspicious links, always verifying the website URL (look for https://), not sharing OTPs, and reporting suspicious communications.

Q7.3: How do I report a suspicious transaction?

Report immediately by calling the 24/7 customer care helpline, through internet banking under Dispute Transaction, or via the bank's mobile app. You can also visit your branch. Block your card if you suspect unauthorized access. File a complaint with the cybercrime portal if needed.

Q7.4: What are the security features of internet banking?

Security features include 128/256-bit SSL encryption, OTP-based two-factor authentication, virtual keyboard, session timeout, IP tracking, device binding, account lock after failed attempts, and real-time transaction alerts. The bank monitors unusual activity patterns 24/7.

Q7.5: How often should I change my banking password?

It is recommended to change your internet banking password every 90 days. Additionally, change it immediately if you suspect it has been compromised. Use a password with at least 8 characters including uppercase, lowercase, numbers, and special characters. Never reuse old passwords.

Q7.6: What is OTP and why is it important?

OTP (One-Time Password) is a temporary, single-use code sent to your registered mobile number or email to verify your identity during transactions. It is valid for a short time (typically 30 seconds to 10 minutes). OTPs ensure unauthorized transactions cannot be completed without your phone.

Q7.7: How do I enable transaction alerts?

Log in to internet banking or the mobile app, go to Settings > Alerts / Notifications, and enable SMS and email alerts for debits, credits, login activities, and large transactions. You can set a threshold amount above which you wish to receive alerts.

Q7.8: What should I do if I receive a suspicious email from the bank?

Do not click any links or download attachments. Do not reply or provide any personal information. Forward the email to the bank's fraud reporting email address. Delete the email. Call the bank's customer care to verify if the communication was genuine.

Q7.9: Can bank employees ask for my password?

No. Bank employees, including customer care staff, will never ask for your password, PIN, OTP, or full card number. If anyone claiming to be from the bank asks for this information, it is a fraud attempt. Hang up and report the incident to the bank immediately.

Q7.10: How do I identify a genuine bank communication?

Genuine bank communication will: address you by name, come from official bank email domains, not ask for sensitive information, not create panic with urgent warnings, and direct you to the bank's official website. When in doubt, call the official customer care number.

Q7.11: What is the bank's fraud protection policy?

The bank offers zero-liability protection for unauthorized transactions if you report them promptly (within 3 days for full protection). Liability may be limited if there is negligence on the customer's part. The bank will investigate and resolve disputes within 90 days as per RBI guidelines.

Q7.12: How do I set transaction limits for security?

Log in to internet banking or the mobile app, go to Card Controls or Transaction Limits, and set daily limits for ATM withdrawals, POS transactions, and online purchases. You can also restrict international usage, contactless payments, or e-commerce transactions individually.

8. Customer Service

Q8.1: What are the customer service hours?

The bank's 24/7 customer care helpline is available round the clock for urgent queries. Branch banking hours are typically 9:30 AM to 4:00 PM, Monday to Friday, and 9:30 AM to 1:00 PM on Saturdays. Branches are closed on Sundays and public holidays. Internet and mobile banking are available 24/7.

Q8.2: How do I contact customer support?

You can reach customer support via: (1) Toll-free helpline (24/7), (2) Branch visit during working hours, (3) Internet banking chat support, (4) Mobile app in-app chat or callback request, (5) Email, or (6) Postal address for written complaints.

Q8.3: Can I visit any branch for my banking needs?

Yes, you can visit any branch of the bank for most services. However, some services like account closure or certain document submissions may require you to visit your home branch. CBS (Core Banking Solution) allows most transactions at any branch across the country.

Q8.4: How do I file a complaint?

You can file a complaint through: internet banking under Service Request > Complaint, mobile app, email, or by visiting a branch and filling out a complaint form. You will receive a reference number to track your complaint status. All complaints must be acknowledged within 3 working days.

Q8.5: What is the escalation process for unresolved issues?

If unsatisfied with the resolution, escalate to the Branch Manager, then to the Zonal/Regional Nodal Officer, and finally to the Banking Ombudsman (RBI) if the issue remains unresolved for 30 days. Contact details for the Ombudsman are available on the RBI website.

Q8.6: How long does it take to resolve a complaint?

Simple complaints are resolved within 3-7 working days. Complex issues (fraud, loan disputes) may take up to 30 working days. As per RBI guidelines, if the complaint is not resolved within 30 days, you can escalate to the Banking Ombudsman.

Q8.7: Can I get assistance in languages other than English?

Yes, the bank's customer care is available in multiple regional languages including Hindi, Tamil, Telugu, Kannada, Malayalam, Marathi, Bengali, and others, depending on the region. Select your preferred language when calling the IVR helpline.

Q8.8: How do I request a callback from customer service?

Log in to the mobile app or internet banking and select Request Callback under Support / Help. Enter your preferred callback time and contact number. A customer service representative will call you within the specified timeframe, usually within 2-4 hours.

Q8.9: Is there a toll-free customer service number?

Yes, the bank provides a toll-free number that is accessible 24/7 at no cost from any mobile or landline within India. The toll-free number is printed on the back of your debit/credit card and on the bank's official website. International callers can use a chargeable number.

Q8.10: How do I provide feedback about banking services?

Share feedback through: internet banking or mobile app under Feedback / Suggestions, the bank's official website feedback form, branch feedback forms, or directly to the Branch Manager. Your feedback is valuable and helps improve banking services.

9. Fees and Charges

Q9.1: What are the ATM withdrawal charges?

Most banks allow 3-5 free ATM transactions per month at their own ATMs and 3 free transactions at other bank ATMs (in metros). Beyond this, charges are 20-21 per financial transaction. In non-metro areas, up to 5 free transactions at other bank ATMs may be available.

Q9.2: Are there any charges for online transactions?

NEFT via internet banking is free as per RBI mandate. IMPS charges 5-15 per transaction. RTGS charges 20-50 depending on the amount. UPI transactions are free for P2P and most P2M payments. Additional charges may apply for international transfers or premium payment services.

Q9.3: What is the fee for checkbook issuance?

The first chequebook (typically 20-25 leaves) is usually free per year. Subsequent chequebooks cost 50-150. Premium and business account holders may receive additional free chequebooks. Emergency or personalized chequebooks may have higher charges.

Q9.4: How much does a demand draft cost?

Demand draft charges typically range from 25 to 250 depending on the amount: Up to 5,000 - 25; 5,001-10,000 - 50; 10,001-1 lakh - 100; above 1 lakh - 150-250. Some banks charge a flat rate or a percentage of the amount.

Q9.5: What are the charges for account closure?

Account closure charges vary: accounts closed within 14 days of opening are typically free. Closure within 14 days to 1 year may attract a charge of 300-1,000. Closure after 1 year is usually free. Some banks waive closure charges entirely.

Q9.6: Is there a penalty for not maintaining minimum balance?

Yes, non-maintenance of the Average Monthly Balance (AMB) attracts a penalty of 100-750 per quarter depending on the shortfall and account type. Some zero-balance accounts like Basic Savings Bank Deposit Accounts do not have this penalty. Check your account terms for specifics.

Q9.7: What are the foreign exchange transaction fees?

Foreign currency transactions on debit/credit cards attract a cross-currency markup of 2-3.5% of the transaction value. Additionally, ATM withdrawals abroad may incur a flat fee of 100-500 per transaction. Always check the applicable exchange rate and charges before transacting abroad.

Q9.8: Are there charges for SMS alerts?

SMS alert charges are typically 15-25 per quarter for standard accounts. Some banks offer free SMS alerts for premium account holders or for a limited number of alerts. You can manage your SMS alert preferences through internet banking or by visiting a branch.

Q9.9: What is the annual fee for credit cards?

Credit card annual fees range from nil (lifetime-free cards) to 500-10,000 or more for premium cards. Most banks waive the annual fee if you spend above a threshold amount in a year. The joining fee for the first year may differ from the annual renewal fee.

Q9.10: How can I get a waiver on certain fees?

Fee waivers are often available if you: maintain a higher-than-required average balance, achieve a certain transaction volume, are a premium or salary account holder, or have a long-standing relationship with the bank. Contact your relationship manager or branch to request applicable fee waivers.

10. General Banking

Q10.1: What is KYC and why is it required?

KYC (Know Your Customer) is a regulatory process mandated by RBI to verify the identity and address of customers. It helps prevent money laundering, fraud, and financial crimes. KYC documents include ID proof (Aadhaar, PAN, passport) and address proof. Without valid KYC, account operations may be restricted.

Q10.2: How do I update my KYC details?

Visit your nearest branch with original and self-attested copies of updated ID and address proof documents. Some banks allow video KYC (V-KYC) for re-verification without a branch visit. KYC must be updated every 2-10 years depending on your risk category as assessed by the bank.

Q10.3: What is IFSC code and where can I find it?

IFSC (Indian Financial System Code) is an 11-character alphanumeric code that uniquely identifies a bank branch for electronic fund transfers. You can find it on your chequebook, passbook, account statement, and the bank's official website. It is required for NEFT, RTGS, and IMPS transfers.

Q10.4: What are the bank's working hours?

Branch working hours are generally 9:30 AM to 4:00 PM on weekdays and 9:30 AM to 1:00 PM on the 2nd and 4th Saturdays. Branches are closed on Sundays, 1st, 3rd and 5th Saturdays, and public holidays. ATMs and digital banking services are available 24/7.

Q10.5: Do you offer services for senior citizens?

Yes, special services for senior citizens (aged 60 and above) include: priority service at branches, higher FD interest rates (0.25-0.50% extra), doorstep banking services, simplified account opening, and dedicated relationship managers at select branches.

Q10.6: What is a demand draft and how is it different from a check?

A Demand Draft (DD) is a pre-paid negotiable instrument issued by the bank, guaranteed for payment. Unlike a personal cheque, a DD cannot bounce since it is backed by the bank's funds. DDs are used for large, secure payments where personal cheques may not be accepted.

Q10.7: How do I get a bank statement?

Bank statements can be obtained via: internet banking (download PDF/Excel), mobile app, email (subscribe to e-statements), passbook update at branch, ATM (mini statement), or by requesting a physical statement at your branch (charges may apply). Statements are available for up to 10 years.

Q10.8: What is MICR code?

MICR (Magnetic Ink Character Recognition) is a 9-digit code printed at the bottom of your cheque leaf in special magnetic ink. It identifies the bank, city, and branch for faster processing of physical cheques. The MICR code is also available on the bank's website and your account passbook.

Q10.9: Can I nominate someone for my account?

Yes, you can nominate up to one person for your savings/FD account. The nominee will receive the account balance in the event of the account holder's death. Nomination can be added at account opening or later by submitting Form DA1 at your branch or through internet banking.

Q10.10: How do I link my PAN card to my account?

Link your PAN by logging into internet banking under Profile > PAN Linking, or by visiting your branch with your PAN card and a copy. PAN linking is mandatory for transactions above 50,000 and to prevent TDS deductions on interest income.

Q10.11: What is the difference between IFSC and SWIFT code?

IFSC (11-character alphanumeric) identifies a specific bank branch within India and is used for domestic transfers (NEFT/RTGS/IMPS). SWIFT code (8-11 characters) identifies a bank globally and is used for international wire transfers. Both codes are unique to each bank branch but serve different transfer

systems.

Q10.12: How do I get a balance certificate from the bank?

Request a balance certificate at your branch or through internet banking under Service Requests > Balance Certificate. It is typically issued within 1-2 working days and may attract a nominal charge of 50-200. It is often required for visa applications, loans, and financial references.